

Financially Well.

Simple insights. Small steps. Lasting change.

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A More Manageable Way to Tackle Debt



Hi {{ contact.FIRSTNAME }},
Debt can make it feel like you should be doing more.

Paying more. Cutting more. Finding a way to make the balance disappear faster. When progress feels slower than you hoped, it's easy to wonder whether your efforts are even making a difference.

If that sounds familiar, you're not alone. A helpful debt strategy does not require extreme measures or a perfect plan. It needs a clear direction you can realistically maintain.

Choose a Direction You Can Keep

When you have more than one balance, it can be difficult to know where to begin.

Should you focus on the smallest balance? The highest interest rate? The account that has been weighing on you the most?

There is more than one reasonable answer.

Paying down your **smallest balance first** can help you experience progress sooner. Focusing on the **highest-interest balance first** can reduce how much interest you pay over time. Prioritizing the **balance that weighs on you most** can help relieve stress and make your progress feel more meaningful.

Any of these approaches can work.

What matters most is choosing one priority, putting any additional amount you can reasonably afford toward that priority, and continuing to make the minimum payments on your other accounts.

The goal is not to find a perfect strategy.

It is to create a plan you can return to, even when some months require adjustments.

Small Steps Toward More Manageable Debt

You don't need to solve everything at once. Start with one or two of these actions:

- **Get a clear picture of what you owe**

Write down each balance, its minimum payment, and its interest rate. Seeing the full picture can make the next decision feel less uncertain.

- **Choose one balance to focus on**

Select the smallest balance if an early win would help you stay encouraged. Start with the highest-interest balance if reducing interest costs is your priority. Or focus on the balance that weighs on you most if addressing it would provide greater peace of mind.

- **Keep the rest of your plan steady**

Continue making at least the minimum payment on your other accounts while protecting the money needed for housing, food, transportation, and other essentials.

- **Find an additional amount that fits your life**

An extra \$10, \$25, or \$50 can move you forward. Choose an amount that feels realistic rather than one that creates additional pressure.

- **Adjust without starting over**

Some months will leave more room than others. If you need to reduce your extra payment for a time, decrease to an amount that works for now and continue when you can.

*Progress is not measured only by how quickly a balance disappears.
It is also measured by having a clearer plan and taking steps you can sustain.*

Your 10-Minute Money Move

Small step. Clear direction.

Set a timer for 10 minutes.

List your debts and write down three details for each:

- Current balance.
- Minimum monthly payment.
- Interest rate.

Then choose one balance to focus on first.

Ask yourself:

"What additional amount could I put toward this balance without making the rest of my month harder?"

Write down that amount, even if it is small.

If there is no room for an additional payment right now, identifying your priority is still meaningful progress. You will know where to direct extra money when it becomes available.

That's enough for this 10-minute money move.

A clearer direction can make a difficult goal feel more manageable.

A Steady Way Forward

Paying down debt rarely happens all at once.

It happens through regular payments, thoughtful decisions, and a willingness to adjust when life changes.

One balance at a time.

One payment at a time.

One realistic step you can repeat.

You don't need a flawless plan to make progress.

You need a direction that fits your life and the confidence to keep moving forward.

Ready for Your Next Step?

If you're working through debt and are unsure how to choose your next step, you do not have to figure it out alone.

Visit buildyourfinancialwellness.com to explore the services available and learn how financial coaching can help you create a practical plan that reflects your priorities and everyday responsibilities.

When you're ready, schedule a **Free Consultation**. It's a calm, no-pressure opportunity to talk through what feels challenging, ask questions, and identify a direction that feels manageable.

Book Your Free Consultation

No pressure. No judgment.

With Care,
TaMara West



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Build Financial Wellness, LLC
429 E Dupont Rd, Unit 2052, Fort Wayne, IN 46825

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